



Wender-Reimherr Adult Attention Deficit Disorder Scale (WRAADDS)

Subject Identification: Date:

Rater:

This interview is intended to measure the severity of the seven target symptoms of the Utah Criteria in adults who have been diagnosed with Attention Deficit Hyperactivity Disorder (ADHD). The scale is not intended to diagnose AD/HD. Clearly, all of these symptoms occur in other psychiatric disorders and this scale is useful only when other disorders have been assessed. **The symptoms should be present chronically although they may be aggravated by stress.**

The scale is most valid when obtained during a joint interview with the subject and a cooperative informant such as a partner, parent, or sibling.

The individual items should be rated as follows:

- 0 – None, not present
- 1 – Mild, somewhat, or sometimes true
- 2 – Clearly present or often true

1. Attention Difficulties	Rating 0 1 2
Do you have difficulties keeping your attention on things, concentrating, focusing?	
Do you have problems with your mind wandering?	
Are you easily distracted?	
Do you have problems concentrating if sounds or any other distractions are present?	
Do you have difficulty keeping your mind on conversations?	
Do others complain that you do not listen, that you do not pay attention to them when they are talking?	
In formal settings such as classes, meetings, church, programs, or lectures, do you have difficulty paying attention to the speaker? (Do not rate this item if the subject does not engage in these activities.)	
Do you have difficulty keeping your mind on reading?	
Do you avoid or dislike reading anything which is not of special interest?	
Do you frequently have to re-read because your mind drifts off, or do you have difficulty comprehending written material?	
2. Hyperactivity/Restlessness:	Rating 0 1 2
Do you have difficulty relaxing?	
Do you often feel restless or tense?	
Are you overactive; do you prefer to be always on the go?	
Do you have difficulty remaining seated at work, school, or home?	
Do you have to get up and move around frequently?	
Are you unable to sit through a movie or TV show?	
Are you fidgety? Do people notice that you are fidgety?	
Do you have difficulty sitting still; do you frequently shift your position?	
Do you drum your fingers, play with things, move your legs, bite your nails, twirl your hair, or tap your feet? (either by report or observation)	

3. Temper:	Rating 0 1 2
Do you frequently feel irritable or angry with your spouse, children, or other family members or at work, driving, or in other situations?	
Do you have angry outbursts or lose your temper easily?	
Do you have a 'short fuse' or a 'low boiling point'?	
Does your temper cause problems for you?	
Do you lose control during temper outbursts? (saying things, you regret, becoming aggressive, acting in a threatening manner, or behaving impulsively)	
4. Affective Lability: Prior to scoring this question, the rater must differentiate between a major mood disorder and the lability of mood in subjects with ADHD ¹ . Complete with BDI-II and MDQ.	Rating 0 1 2
Does your mood change frequently, going up and down like a roller coaster in the sense of getting sad or feeling 'up'?	
Do you often have periods of being sad, blue, or discouraged?	
During these periods, are you overly self-critical or down on yourself?	
Do you often feel bored?	
Do you easily lose interest in things?	
Do you have periods of being excessively active, hyper, getting too excited, going too fast, or talking too much?	
5. Emotional Over reactivity:	Rating 0 1 2
Do you easily get feelings of being overwhelmed?	
Do you frequently feel 'hassled', frustrated?	
Do you overreact to pressure, blow things out of proportion?	
Do small problems seem too difficult; do you make mountains out of molehills?	
When these reactions occur, do you have difficulties in managing tasks or getting things done?	
With pressures or stresses, do you become anxious, disorganized, or confused?	
6. Disorganization:	Rating 0 1 2
Do you have problems with organization at home, work, or school?	
Do you have difficulties organizing your time, setting priorities, working in an organized manner?	
Do you jump from one task to another before finishing the first?	
Do you have trouble with stick-to-it-ive-ness?	
Do you start projects, but have trouble staying with them to completion?	
Are you forgetful?	
Do you forget to return phone calls or to keep appointments?	
Do you frequently misplace things like keys, purse, wallet, or things around the house or at work?	
Do you have problems getting started, putting things off, procrastinating?	
Do you put off everything to the last minute?	
Do you have trouble meeting deadlines?	

¹ ADHD-related dysphoria is generally brief, lasting hours, and usually has an identifiable precipitant. The exception is when the subject experiences persistent life problems (often self-produced), when the period of dysphoria may be extended. Similarly, distinguish between excitement (which may be mild) and overenthusiasm from mood elevation with a manic quality. ADHD subjects may be comorbid for a major depression. Determine duration and frequency of episodes and presence of somatic concomitants to help distinguish discouragement, moodiness, and demoralization found in ADHD from Major Depression with its loss of interest and loss of the ability to experience pleasure.

7. Impulsivity:	Rating 0 1 2
Do you have problems with being impulsive?	
Do you frequently jump into things without thinking?	
Do you make sudden decisions without thinking?	
Are you impulsive in talking?	
Do you interrupt others? Do you finish sentences for others?	
Do you say things without thinking, or blurt things out?	
Do you frequently regret what you have said?	
Are you impulsive with money?	
Do you impulse buy or have trouble managing money?	
Do you rush through activities or work, try to do things too quickly?	
Do you frequently ignore details?	
Do you make careless mistakes?	
Are you impatient, or unable to wait?	
Do others regard you as impatient (friends, family)?	

The summary scores should be based on the ratings of the specific questions, together with any other symptoms in the area reported by the subject.

The summary score should not be a simple average of the individual ratings.

If only one question group is rated as clearly present, a rating of '4' might be appropriate if this one factor is causing significant problems.

Subcategories	Summary Rating 0 1 2 3 4
Attention Difficulties	
Hyperactivity/Restlessness	
Temper	
Affective Lability	
Emotional Over reactivity	
Disorganization	
Impulsivity	
Total Score (sum of 7 summary items)	

Summary Ratings:

0 – None

1 – Mild

2 – Moderate

3 – Quite a bit

4 – Very much

A total score suggesting of ADHD is considered by the authors to be >18, although there is no data, and it is the user's decision.